

Bendy legs!

African harrier hawks have long legs which they use to reach eggs, chicks, and bats inside holes in trees. To make it easier to snatch a meal, they can bend their legs backward, forward, and even sideways.



Working together

Raptors do not hurt humans, and for many hundreds of years, they have been trained to hunt with people. In the Middle Ages, this lanner falcon would have been flown by a squire, a boy who worked for a knight.

The glove stops the bird's claws from scratching you.



Birds of prey have excellent color vision.

Nostril

This powerful, hooked beak is used to pull apart animals that are too big to be swallowed whole.

Like all birds of prey, peregrines spend most of the day resting or preening, not hunting.

Many birds of prey have bare legs, but others wear feathered "pants."

This needle-sharp claw, or talon, is used to grab prey.

Meat-eating birds

American kestrel



Goshawk



All-American eagle

This US army badge has a bald eagle on it because it is the national bird of the United States.

Harpy eagle

